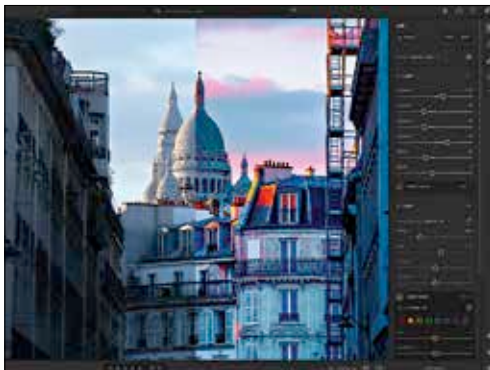


Adobe Photoshop

Photoshop, arguably the most well-known of all design tools for Windows, has dominated the industry for the past three decades and is still the go-to for studios worldwide. Indeed, you'll have a hard time finding work if you don't know how to use it. Of course, if you're a freelancer, you'll have more freedom to use other applications, but it'll be impossible to escape it entirely.

Is it, however, any good? You don't stay on top in an ever-expanding business for no reason, and Adobe has made strong attempts to improve its product to keep it relevant until 2022. The new neural filters, as well as the advanced 3D modelling and 3D printing features, are particularly appealing. Addition-



Can't beat this

ally, the iPad version is a useful feature (find out more in our Photoshop for iPad review). This app is becoming more sophisticated by the day; for example, Adobe has incorporated cloud document version history as well as offline support for cloud documents.

The key reason to consider a different

option is cost. Photoshop, like the rest of Adobe's software, is now only available as part of a Creative Cloud subscription, which isn't cheap.

However, there are reductions available (check out the most recent Creative Cloud discounts), and if you use numerous CC tools, the interoperability between them, as well as other services like Adobe Fonts and Adobe Stock, can sometimes make the extra cost a worthwhile investment in your business.

Adobe Illustrator

Since its introduction in 1987, Adobe Illustrator has been the natural companion to Photoshop for generations of illustrators and designers, and it has long been regarded as the industry's standard vector drawing tool. With the influx of new competitors into the space, that dominance is starting to wane a little. However, it remains one of the most popular design tools for Windows.